

Abiodun M. Musbaudeen

Department of Economics
Binghamton University (SUNY)

Phone: (607) 760-7889
E-mail: amusbau1@binghamton.edu
abiodunmusbaudeen.github.io

Teaching Statement

My teaching aims to help students approach unfamiliar problems with confidence and explain the reasoning behind their answers. I support this through clear explanations, regular practice, and opportunities to identify and work through difficulties with me and with classmates.

At Binghamton University, I taught **Statistical Methods in Summer 2025**. My teaching assistantships span introductory and intermediate microeconomics, introductory macroeconomics, econometrics, and data analytics; in Introduction to Econometrics, I also lead R instruction. I am prepared to teach these areas, managerial economics, and applied electives in causal inference and panel data. Across courses, I use students' questions and explanations to examine their understanding.

Responding to Students' Learning Needs

In Introduction to Econometrics, students struggled with the Gauss–Markov assumptions and the derivation of ordinary least squares (OLS) estimators, and the concepts of unbiasedness, variance, and hypothesis testing. I responded by slowing down and returning to foundational explanations, with extra classes and additional office hours to work through these ideas. I connected the concepts and problems to real-life examples and reinforced the explanations with practical examples in the lab. My purpose was to help students connect the assumptions and mathematical steps to the meaning of an estimate. I then asked students to explain the concepts back to me in their own words. Their follow-up explanations showed improved understanding of the concepts we had revisited. This experience reinforced my emphasis on returning to foundations, connecting ideas to applications, and checking understanding through students' own reasoning.

I organize my teaching around the work students do between explanations. Following a solution during a lecture is only one step toward being able to solve a problem independently. I assigned weekly homework to give students regular opportunities to attempt the material, and I provided additional practice questions to support preparation for assessments. My purpose was to encourage sustained engagement and give students time to identify a difficulty, return to an explanation, and try again before an examination.

To support that process, I created online lecture videos on course topics and difficult concepts and uploaded my slides and lecture notes. I did this because a single explanation at a fixed pace cannot meet every student's needs. With a recording, students can pause at a difficult step and revisit it alongside the notes while working on a question. Making these resources available gives students more control over the pace of their learning. I see the homework and supporting materials as connected: practice gives students a reason to revisit an explanation, and the explanation supports their next attempt.

Using Explanations to Examine Understanding

I want students to understand why a method applies and what an answer means. In my microeconomics teaching, I begin with an economic question before developing the formal argument. When discussing a tax, for example, I ask students to predict its effects, work through the graph, and explain the result in words. The purpose of moving between a prediction, a diagram, and a verbal explanation is to make the reasoning visible. It gives students several ways to approach the problem and gives me a basis for assessing what they understand beyond the final answer.

I also created an online collaboration platform where students could discuss difficult concepts with classmates before bringing unresolved questions to me. The purpose was to make explaining an idea part of learning it. Putting a question into words and considering another student's approach offer ways to examine one's own understanding. I complemented this space with flexible office hours and encouraged students to contact me when questions arose. Together, these practices made room for both peer discussion and individual support.

These activities reflect the standard guiding my assessment: students should be able to explain their choices and interpret their answers. I listen for the connection between an idea, the steps used to apply it, and the conclusion. An explanation provides a basis for deciding what needs further attention, alongside the evidence provided by homework and examinations.

Building Confidence and Purpose

Students bring different levels of preparation and confidence to quantitative courses. I want them to have a practical next step when they become stuck and to regard asking a question as an ordinary part of learning.

My experience in banking, e-commerce, and media analytics also informs why I emphasize clear interpretation and communication. In econometrics, students work with reproducible R scripts that connect data preparation, estimation, and interpretation. I emphasize documentation because an analysis needs to be understandable to someone who did not produce it. These habits help students prepare for further study and for work in which colleagues rely on their analysis to make decisions.

The purpose of my teaching is to help students become more capable learners: willing to attempt a difficult question, able to explain their reasoning, and ready to seek help or further evidence when needed. I support that development through regular practice, accessible explanations, and opportunities to work through questions with others.